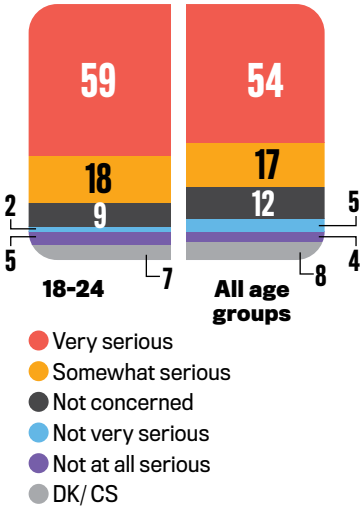


ANI

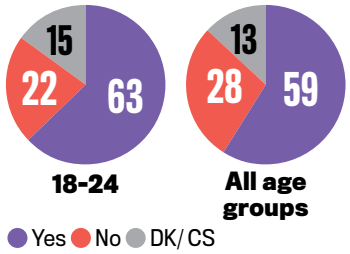
Nearly 60 per cent of the youth find the state of unemployment in the country very serious

Q. *How do you view the unemployment situation in the country?*



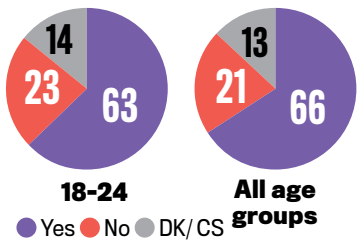
More than 60 per cent of the young respondents support a national caste census

Q. *Do you think there should be a caste census across the country?*



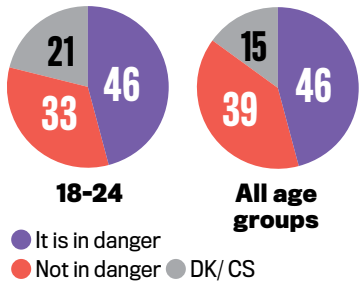
Those aged between 18 and 24 also want one nation, one poll

Q. *Do you support the idea of a one nation, one poll?*



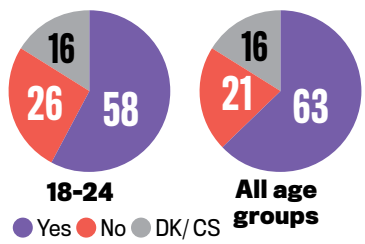
There is a concern among the youth about the democratic norms of the country

Q. *How do you rate the current state of democracy in India?*



Support for UCC is less among the youth than all age groups

Q. *Should India implement the Uniform Civil Code?*



Figures in percentage

gets to register 5,000-20,000 eligible young voters in each assembly segment. A five-member committee led by BJP Yuva Morcha national president Tejasvi Surya has been tasked with spearheading a youth-centric campaign across the nation. "Young voters are new India's decision-makers," says Surya, who has been doing several townhalls with young voters. "Their aspirations fuel Prime Minister Narendra Modi's vision for Viksit Bharat."

It is a vote bank that the Congress and other Opposition parties are eyeing too. His 53 years make Rahul Gandhi a relatively 'young' leader, perhaps making it easier for him to establish a connect with the youth. Nowhere was this more evident than during the Congress scion's Bharat Jodo Yatra last year, where not only did he personally interact with people—youth among them—during his stopovers across the length of the country but whose progress was also meticulously relayed via social media platforms popular among youth. Different social media content strategies around Rahul Gandhi is what the party is crafting closer to the election too. The Congress election war room team is strictly monitoring what is clicking with its young audience and what is not. Instagram is the preferred platform for this outreach, given that youngsters are glued to it the most. A series of townhalls in several places, including in colleges and universities, is also on the anvil. And while the BJP is hoping to lure the youth with its futuristic vision of Viksit Bharat, the Congress is raking up the here and now, attacking what it thinks to be the BJP's Achilles heel—unemployment.

Will the Job Plank Work?

The share of unemployed Indians in the 15-29 age group may have dropped to 83 per cent in 2022 from 89 per cent in 2000, but the quality of jobs remains a continuing concern, as does disguised unemployment. The share of educated among the unemployed youth in the same period climbed to 66 per cent from 54 per cent, according to the India Employment Report 2024 published jointly by the International Labour Organiza-